Aston University

Home Undergraduate Scholarship Eligibility Criteria 2022-23

April 2022

This document sets out the scholarship offerings for home undergraduate students whose year of entry is 2022/23

Reference Number	Version Letter	Officer Responsible for Procedures	Consultation Process	Date of Approval and Committee and/or Senior Management Officer	Effective Date
	1	Director of Student and Academic Services	University Scholarship Group		

Home Undergraduate Scholarship Eligibility Criteria 2022-23

1. SCOPE

1.1 Purpose

The purpose of this document is to outline the eligibility criteria and amount of funding available for home undergraduate students to receive scholarships from Aston University starting undergraduate degree programmes in 2022/23.

1.2 What is covered by the eligibility criteria

This document sets out:

- *The basis on which students entering in 2022/23 will be eligible and assessed for home undergraduate scholarships and the amounts awarded at each stage of the academic year.*
- *The implications of withdrawal or leave of absence on students' eligibility for scholarships.*

1.3 Who is covered by the eligibility criteria

All home undergraduate students entering in 2022/23 should be aware of and comply with this document. All those who undertake a role relating to the payment of scholarships at the University, including staff, must be aware of and comply with this document.

1.4 Ownership

The Director of Student and Academic Services is the officer responsible for this document. Any questions about the operation of this document should be referred in the first instance to the Director of Academic Services.

2. GLOSSARY OF TERMS

The terms set out in this section 2 apply to this document.

Academic Term: The academic year is divided into three academic terms for undergraduate payment arrangements.

Academic year: This is the period over which Aston University teaches a programme. For most undergraduate programmes, this normally begins at the start of October and ends in the middle of June. Students should normally be in attendance during this period.

Attendance: For the purposes of Aston Scholarship approvals, a student is considered to be in attendance if Aston University's student records systems show that they are a current student. Attendance requirements to pass a degree programme may differ and should be clarified with the specific programme leader.

Care Leaver: For the purposes of this document, a care leaver is defined as: a young person (under the age of 25) who:

- has been in the care of, or been given accommodation by, their local authority (LA) for a period of at least 13 weeks before the age of 16, and hasn't reconciled with their parents between leaving care and starting their course.
- Has not reconciled with their parents between leaving care and starting their programme of study.
- Students will be asked to provide a letter from their Local Authority confirming their care leaver status and also confirmation from either Student Finance England, Student Finance Wales, Student

Finance Northern Ireland, Student Awards Agency for Scotland or Student Finance Services that they have been awarded full funding as a care leaver.

Children from Military Families: For the purposes of this document, children from military families are defined as students who have a parent or guardian who has previously or currently serves in the UK armed forces. The UK armed forces is defined as The British Army, The Royal Navy, The Royal Marines or The Royal Air Force.

Deferred studies: This is when exams and/or assessments are delayed until an agreed period of time has elapsed**.**

Equivalent or Lower Qualification: A student holds an Equivalent or Lower Qualification if they already hold an awarded qualification which is at the same level as or is higher than the programme they will be studying at Aston University.

Home student: The rules about qualifying as a home student depend on nationality, the immigration status of you and your family members and where you have all been living. This is a student who qualifies to be considered for a tuition fee loan and grants and loans for living costs from the UK government.

Household Income: This is the household income as calculated by the relevant funding authority for a student's application for student funding from the UK government. It is not possible for Aston University to accept any alternative assessment method of a student's household income.

My Aston Portal (MAP): This is the Aston University online student portal through which students can view and update personal information and find information about their programme. Students will be able to access information about the progress of Aston Scholarship assessments and approvals from their student homepage on MAP.

Placement year: This is a period of industrial, professional, linguistic or occupational training/work experience or study abroad which is approved by the University and forms part of the assessment for a sandwich degree or language degree at Aston University. Sometimes a student is paid during their placement for the work they do by their placement employer which is called a paid placement. In other cases, students do not receive any money from their placement employer for their work and this is called an unpaid placement. If the placement takes place outside of the UK then it is considered to be a work or study placement overseas. A placement year also incorporates those undertaking an integrated work based learning year as part of an Integrated Masters Programme (MEng/MBiol/MOptom/MPharm/MPhys).

Re-enrolment: All students are expected to re-enrol each September, irrespective of their start date. The purpose of re-enrolment is to confirm that the student accepts the University's terms and conditions and the University's Regulations for that specific academic year. The re-enrolment process is also used to update any changes to the student's personal information. Re-enrolment is via MAP and the student will be emailed when the MAP task is available for the student to complete.

Refugees: For the purposes of this document, refugees are defined as students who have a vignette or Biometric Residence Permit associated to an international passport that states they have been granted full refugee status in the UK. This does not include students who have Indefinite Leave to Remain or another permanent residence status in the UK.

Repeating studies as if for the first time: This is when exams, assessments or modules are retaken but are treated as a first attempt and the mark the student receives is not limited to the pass mark, this is usually due to exceptional circumstances that are agreed on an individual case by case basis.

Repeating studies with attendance: This is when a student does not progress to the next level of study and has to retake exams and/or assessments in the following year and is required to attend all of the lectures, classes and tutorials for those modules.

Repeating studies without attendance: This is when a student does not progress to the next level of study and has to retake exams and/or assessments in the following year and is not required to attend any of the lectures, classes and tutorials for those modules.

Repeating studies with partial attendance: This is when a student has to retake exams, assessments and/or modules in the following year and is required to attend some of the lectures, classes and tutorials for those modules.

Satisfactory academic performance: For the purposes of Aston Scholarship approvals, a student is considered to have a satisfactory academic performance if they have been accepted to start the first year of their programme or they have been considered by an Examination Board to have passed and to be eligible to progress into the next stage of study.

Special Support Grant: This is a grant for living costs from the UK Government which is for students who have an entitlement to receive Social Security Benefits (for example they have children or are disabled). It is assessed and awarded by the relevant Student Finance body.

Sponsor: For the purposes of this document, a sponsor is an external organisation, not a family member nor the Student Loans Company.

Stage of study:
Stage 1 equates to the entry to year 1 of a degree programme or year 0 of the Integrated Foundation Year Programme,
Stage 2 follows stage 1 after successful completion of that year of study,
Stage P is the placement/sandwich year and often follows stage 2,
Stage 3 follows stage 2 after successful completion of that year of study for those students whose programme of study is made up of four or more taught years of study e.g. MPharm
Stage F is the final year of study of a degree programme.

Student Awards Agency for Scotland: This is the organisation that assesses and awards student funding from the UK government to Home students who live in Scotland.

Student Finance England: This is the organisation that assesses and awards student funding from the UK government to Home students who live in England.

Student Finance Northern Ireland: This is the organisation that assesses and awards student funding from the UK government to Home students who live in Northern Ireland.

Student Finance Wales: This is the organisation that assesses and awards student funding from the UK government to Home students who live in Wales.

Student Loans Company: This is the organisation that manages the payment and repayment of loans and grants for student support funding. This organisation is also responsible for collating information about household income and sharing this information with Universities for bursary and scholarship assessments.

Suspending studies (Leave of Absence):
This is when a student stops their studies for a period (normally longer than 60 days) for reasons such as illness. This is also sometimes called a Leave of Absence.

UCAS: This stands for the University and Colleges Admission System. It is the system students use to apply for undergraduate places at universities and colleges in the UK.

Widening Participation Group: A student can be determined to be in this group for the purposes of scholarship assessment where they have received a 'contextual offer' at application stage and/or have a family income of less than or equal to £42,875 per annum.

3. GENERAL PROVISIONS

A student qualifies to be considered for an Aston Scholarship if:

(a) the student will start a new full time undergraduate degree programme at Aston University between 1st September 2022 and the 31st August 2023.

(b) the student will be liable to pay the full time Year 1 and Placement Undergraduate tuition fees confirmed for that academic year. These fee amounts are subject to inflationary increases in line with government policy.

(c) the student is classified as a home fee payer and is in receipt of UK student support funding.

(d) the student qualifies to receive student support funding as part of the finance arrangements for new students starting their degree programmes between 1st September 2022 and the 31st August 2023.

A student who is awarded a scholarship will be eligible to receive that scholarship in line with the conditions that applied in their original year of entry irrespective of subsequent transfers or suspension of studies.

The household income thresholds used to assess eligibility for the award of a scholarship approved on household income will be reviewed once in the academic year where a student enters stage 1 of a programme of study.

A student will not be entitled to receive a scholarship in any academic year for which they do not have to pay tuition fees. Students who are repeating their studies are not eligible for scholarships regardless of whether they are repeating with attendance, without attendance, or with partial attendance.

With the exception of a placement year, a student will only be eligible to be considered for an Aston Scholarship approved on household income for an academic year if they have made an application to be income assessed for the same year by Student Finance England, Student Finance Wales, Student Finance Northern Ireland or Student Awards Agency for Scotland.

A student who has their fees paid by a sponsor will not be eligible for an Aston Scholarship.

A student will not be eligible to receive a scholarship in full or in part if they are, at the time when payment is due to be made to them, considered by the University to be in academic debt as outlined in the Tuition Fee Charging Policy. For the purposes of this document, a student will be considered to be in academic debt to the University if they have received the third notice that a payment is overdue.

4. APPROVING AND AWARDING

4.1 Annual review

Aston University reviews its portfolio of scholarships on an annual basis. Scholarships offered for one entry cohort may not be offered for following cohorts. The terms and conditions of specific scholarships may differ dependent on the year of first offering**.**

4.2 Scholarship awards

Students will only be approved for Aston Scholarships once in an academic year. Scholarship entitlement will normally be determined by the 30th November 2022 using the information that is available to Aston University at that time. Any scholarship assessments which cannot be considered at the end of November because the required information is not yet available will be reviewed on a monthly basis until all relevant information has been received and the student's scholarship entitlement can be determined. It is not normally possible to consider a student for an award of an Aston Scholarship after 30th May of the academic year in question.

Students do not need to apply to be considered for a scholarship because Aston University will use UCAS data, household income information provided by the Student Loans Company and information held on University records for placement years, to determine awards. Students who are eligible for one or more of the Aston Scholarships will receive communications concerning their award/s through My Aston Portal (MAP).

Students who are eligible for one or more scholarships where a payment choice is available will be required to confirm the format they wish that scholarship to take, in line with the choices offered in the first term of each academic year. This confirmation of choice will be final and will not be amended.

For Aston Scholarships where eligible students are given a choice of award, students must make their choices by the deadline that will be published on MAP.

For Aston Scholarships where eligible students are given a choice of award and they have selected payment directly into their bank account, students must provide their bank account details when asked to by the published deadline on MAP.

For Aston Scholarships where eligible students are given a choice of award and a student does not make a choice by the published deadline, the award will default to a tuition fee discount.

Students must provide their bank account details when asked to by the published deadline on MAP. If the student does not provide bank details by the published deadline, for scholarships where students are given a choice of award, the award will default to a tuition fee discount, and for scholarships where there is no choice of award and they are only awarded as a bank transfer, the scholarship will be rejected.

4.3 Scholarships and the Student Loans Company

The Student Loans Company charges interest on tuition fee loans at a daily rate from the date payments are made to universities. Aston University cannot accept any responsibility for interest applied to tuition fee loans by the Student Loans Company.

Eligibility for a scholarship approved on household income will be determined on the basis of information provided by the Student Loans Company once the student has been fully enrolled on the degree programme. Aston University aims to consider scholarships based on household income within eight weeks of receiving household income information from the Student Loans Company. Any student who is approved for an income-based scholarship will be notified via MAP. The University will notify the Student Loans Company about fee discounts and changes in tuition fee liability.

Where a student has a choice to take their scholarship in the form of tuition fee discount and has taken out a tuition fee loan from the Student Loans Company, the University is required to notify the Student Loans Company of any changes in a student's tuition fee liability. If a student has taken out the maximum tuition fee loan available to pay their tuition fee in full, their maximum tuition fee loan entitlement and payments should be adjusted accordingly by the Student Loans Company. If a student has only taken a partial tuition

fee loan to pay part of their tuition fees, the student will need to contact the Student Loans Company to adjust the amount of loan they wish to borrow.

4.4 Scholarships and the placement year

Eligibility for a scholarship during a placement year will be approved on the basis of information held on University records about previous scholarship approvals and placement details. Approvals of scholarships for placement years will be communicated to students via MAP usually by the end of term one of that academic year. The University will notify the Student Loans Company about any fee discounts and changes in tuition fee liability.

Students who have been assessed as eligible for a Placement Scholarship but whose eligibility changes after the award has been confirmed for reasons other than income related, may have their award amended on a pro-rata basis to reflect the period of time that the eligibility was in place. Students will be liable to repay any overpayment of the award that may result from this.

Students who have been assessed as eligible for a Placement Scholarship need to have their placement record approved in the student records system by the end of January of the relevant academic year the placement falls within. Failure to get a placement approved by this date will make the student ineligible for the scholarship.

4.5 Withdrawing from, repeating or suspension of studies

Aston Scholarships will normally only be available to students who have been in attendance, as defined by the University throughout term one and term two and are still in attendance at the start of term three. Students who withdraw from Aston University part way through an academic year will not be eligible to receive a scholarship in respect of that year. Any Aston Scholarship applied to the student for that academic year will be revoked and the full cost for that period will be recovered.

Students who are repeating their studies are not eligible for scholarships regardless of whether they are repeating with attendance, without attendance, or with partial attendance.

Where a student suspends their studies and takes a Leave of Absence for a complete academic year, no tuition fee is charged and, therefore, the student will not be eligible to receive a scholarship.

Students who suspend their studies part way through an academic year will be eligible to receive a scholarship for the academic terms they have completed in full. Students who suspend their studies and return from a suspension of studies part way through an academic year will only be eligible to receive a scholarship for the terms they will complete in full. The amount of scholarship will be approved on a pro rata basis and in line with the Tuition Fee Charging Policy for that academic year.

4.5 Reassessment

Where a scholarship is based on academic achievement, the qualifications used to assess the information will be based upon information provided by UCAS for qualifications where results are supplied via UCAS or at enrolment for all other qualifications. If qualification grades are improved based on a reassessment, scholarship assessments may be reconsidered if appropriate evidence is accepted by the Aston Admissions Department. Where a student is reassessed in a qualification, it is the student's responsibility to supply this information to the Admissions Department so that it can be considered, failure to do this will mean that it is not possible to consider any reassessment. Any reassessment information must be supplied and assessed prior to the 31st May of the 2022/23 academic year to be considered.

5. INDIVIDUAL ELIGIBILTY CRITERIA FOR HOME UNDERGRADUATE SCHOLARSHIPS

Aston University offers a variety of scholarships which have individual eligibility criteria in addition to the general provisions outlined in section 3 and approving and awarding criteria as listed in section 4.

5.1 Aston Achievement Scholarship

A student is eligible to receive an Aston Achievement Scholarship if:

(a) at enrolment the student meets the general provisions outlined in Section 3, and
(b) prior to enrolment the student has achieved grades BBB+ in their A levels (or equivalent qualifications as outlined in Section 7). The grades refer to the student's highest achieved qualifications, and
(c) the student is not eligible to receive an Aston Vice-Chancellors Achievement Scholarship. The student is not in a widening participation group. For the purposes of this scholarship we are defining a widening participation group as being a student who received a 'contextual offer' at application stage and/or has a family income of less than or equal to £42,875 per annum.

A student who is awarded an Aston Achievement Scholarship will be eligible when they enter stage 1 of a programme of study to receive a payment of £500, paid in two equal instalments of £250 into their bank account in the second and third terms.

Students who are entering stage 0 of the Integrated Foundation Year Programme and meet all the other criteria will receive their scholarship as they enter stage 0. These students will not be eligible for a further Aston Achievement Scholarship in stage 1 of their chosen degree programme.

Eligibility for an Aston Scholarship based on achievement will normally be approved on the basis of information provided by UCAS. Eligibility for Aston Scholarships based on achievement will be communicated to students by Aston University and will normally be confirmed by the end of November 2022. Information will be available through the student homepage on MAP. Notification will be sent to the Student Loans Company about fee discounts and changes in tuition fee liability where appropriate by Aston University.

A student cannot be awarded the Aston Achievement Scholarship if they meet the criteria for the Aston Vice-Chancellors Achievement Scholarship. If a student meets the criteria for both of these scholarships they will be awarded the Aston Vice-Chancellors Achievement Scholarship only.

5.2 Aston Vice-Chancellors Achievement Scholarship

A student is eligible to receive an Aston Vice-Chancellors Achievement Scholarship if:

(a) at enrolment the student meets the general provisions outlined in section 4, and
(b) prior to enrolment the student has achieved grades BBB+ in their A levels (or equivalent qualifications as outlined in Section 7). The grades refer to the student's highest qualifications, not their entry qualifications. and
(c) the student is in a widening participation group. For the purposes of this scholarship we are defining a widening participation group as being a student who received a 'contextual offer' at application stage and/or has a family income of less than or equal to £42,875 per annum.

A student who is awarded an Aston Vice-Chancellors Achievement Scholarship will be eligible when they enter stage 1 of a programme of study to receive a payment of £500, paid in two equal instalments of £250 into their bank account in the second and third terms.

Students who are entering stage 0 of the Integrated Foundation Year Programme and meet all the other criteria will receive their scholarship as they enter stage 0. These students will not be eligible for a further Aston Vice-Chancellors Achievement Scholarship in stage 1 of their chosen degree programme.

Eligibility for an Aston Scholarship based on achievement will normally be approved on the basis of information provided by UCAS. Eligibility for Aston Scholarships based on achievement will be communicated to students by Aston University and will normally be confirmed by the end of November 2022. Information will be available through the student homepage on MAP. Notification will be sent to the Student Loans Company about fee discounts and changes in tuition fee liability where appropriate by Aston University.

A student cannot be awarded both the Aston Vice-Chancellors Achievement Scholarship and the Aston Achievement Scholarship. If they meet the criteria for both of these scholarships, they will be awarded the Aston Vice-Chancellors Achievement Scholarship only.

5.3 Aston Aspiration Scholarship

A student is eligible to receive an Aston Aspiration Scholarship in the academic year 2022/23 if:

(a) at enrolment in the academic year 2022/2023 the student meets the general provisions outlined in section 4, and
(b) the student is regarded as a home student for fee purposes, is eligible for UK student support funding, and
(c) the student has currently been assessed by either Student Finance England, Student Finance Wales, Student Finance Northern Ireland or Student Awards Agency for Scotland to have a household income of up to and including £42,875.

A student who is awarded an Aston Aspiration Scholarship will be eligible when they enter stage 2 of a programme of study to receive a payment of £500, paid in two equal instalments of £250 into their bank account in the second and third terms.

Students who are entering stage 0 of the Integrated Foundation Year Programme and meet all the other criteria will receive their scholarship as they enter stage 1. These students will not be eligible for a further Aspiration Scholarship in stage 2 of their chosen degree programme.

A student who is awarded an Aston Aspiration Scholarship will be eligible when they enter stage 2 Eligibility for a scholarship approved on household income will be considered on the basis of information provided by the Student Loans Company once the student has been fully enrolled on the degree programme. Aston University aims to consider and approve scholarships based on household income within eight weeks of

receiving household income information from the Student Loans Company. Any student who is approved for an income-based scholarship will be notified via MAP.

5.4 Aston Placement Scholarship

A student is eligible to receive an Aston Placement Scholarship if:

(a) the student meets the general provisions outlined in Section 4, and
(b) the student is undertaking an unpaid placement for their sandwich placement year, or
(c) the student is undertaking a work or study placement overseas, or
(d) the student is undertaking the Integrated Masters Programme (MEng/MBiol/MOptom/MPharm/MPhys) integrated work based learning year.

A student who is awarded an Aston Placement Scholarship will be eligible to choose between receiving either:

(a) £1,250 tuition fee discount,
or
(b) a payment of £1,250, paid in two equal instalments of £625 into their bank account in the second and third terms.

A student can only be awarded one scholarship for the placement year so students cannot receive any other Scholarship awards for this specific year.

5.5 Aston Support Scholarship

The Aston Support Scholarship is targeted at students classified as being in one of the following groups as defined in the glossary:

- UK domiciled students who have identified that they are a care leaver at pre-enrolment.
- Children from military families
- Refugees

A student is eligible to receive an Aston Support Scholarship if:

(a) at enrolment the student meets the general provisions outlined in Section 4, and
(b) the student is regarded as a home student for fee purposes, is eligible to receive UK student support funding, and
(c) the student has identified that they are a care leaver at pre-enrolment, meets the definition provided in the document and provides a letter from their local authority confirming their care leaver status and also confirmation from SFE that they have been awarded full funding as a care leaver. This evidence is to be provided by the deadline which will be published on MAP.

Or

the student has identified that they are a child from a military family at pre-enrolment, meets the definition provided in the document and has provided evidence to show that they are from a military family by the deadline which will be published on MAP.

Or

the student meets the definition of a refugee as provided in the document and has provided evidence to show that they have been granted full refugee status in the UK by the deadline which will be published on MAP.

A student who is awarded an Aston Support Scholarship will be eligible when they enter stage 1 of a programme of study to receive:

(a) a payment of £1250, paid in two equal instalments of £625 into their bank account in the second and third terms for each year they are enrolled on their programme of study.

(b) In their Placement Year they can choose to receive this payment as either:

(i) a £1,250 tuition fee discount,
or
(ii) a payment of £1,250, paid in two equal instalments of £625 into their bank account in the second and third terms.

Students who are entering stage 0 of the Integrated Foundation Year Programme and meet all the other criteria will receive their scholarship as they enter stage 0 rather than stage 1.

A student can only be awarded one scholarship for the placement year so students cannot receive any other Scholarship awards for this specific year.

5.6 Aston Mature Adult Learners Scholarship

The Aston Mature Adult Learners Scholarship is targeted at UK students who are aged 21 or over at the start of their undergraduate programme of study and are studying their first degree.

A student is eligible to receive an Aston Mature Adult Learners Scholarship if:

(a) the student meets the general provisions outlined in Section 4, and
(b) at the start of their degree course are aged twenty one years or over and
(c) the student has not previously completed a first degree.

A student who is awarded an Aston Mature Adult Learners Scholarship will be eligible to receive: a payment of £500, paid in two equal instalments of £250 into their bank account in the second and third terms for each stage of study excluding the Placement Year.

Eligibility for an Aston Mature Adult Learners Scholarship will normally be approved on the basis of information available in the University record system. Eligibility for Aston Mature Adult Learners Scholarships will be communicated to students by Aston University and will normally be confirmed by the end of November 2022. Information will be available through the student homepage on MAP.

5.7 Aston Aspire Placement Scholarship

The Aston Aspire Placement Scholarship is targeted at UK domiciled students who have been assessed by Student Finance England, Student Finance Wales, Student Finance Northern Ireland or Student Awards Agency for Scotland to have a household income up to and including £42,875 and are undertaking a placement year.

A student is eligible to receive an Aston Aspire Placement Scholarship if:

(a) the student meets the general provisions outlined in Section 4, and
(b) the student is regarded as a home student for fee purposes, is eligible to receive UK student support funding, and
(c) the student is assessed at the beginning of their programme of study by either Student Finance England, Student Finance Wales, Student Finance Northern Ireland or Student Awards Agency for Scotland to have a household income of up to and including £42,875.
(d) the student is undertaking a sandwich placement year, or
(e) the student is undertaking the Integrated Masters Programme (MEng/MBiol/MOptom/MPharm/MPhys/MBCHB) integrated work based learning year

A student who is awarded an Aston Aspire Placement Scholarship will be eligible to choose in their Placement Year between receiving either:

(i) a £1,250 tuition fee discount,
or
(ii) a payment of £1,250, paid in two equal instalments of £625 into their bank account in the second and third terms.

A student can only be awarded one scholarship for the placement year so students cannot receive any other Scholarship awards for this specific year.

5.8 Aston Success Scheme

The Aston Success Scheme is targeted at new Home students enrolling in the 2022/23 academic year.

A student is eligible to receive an Aston Success Scheme payment if:

(a) At enrolment the student meets the general provisions outlined in Section 4, and
(b) the student is regarded as a home student for fee purposes, is eligible to receive UK student support funding, and
(c) the student has completed formal enrolment an all associated checks related to enrolment including qualifications have been confirmed by the end of Term 1,and
(d) the student is not eligible to receive the Aston Widening Participation Success Scheme, a student can only receive either the Aston Success Scheme or the Aston Widening Participation Success Scheme, they are unable to receive both of these in any academic year.

A student who is awarded the Aston Success Scheme will be eligible when they enter stage 1 of a programme of study to receive a credit of £50 paid into their bank account in term one.

In each subsequent stage of study excluding the placement year, provided they continue to meet all the general conditions as set out in Section 4 they will receive a credit of £50 paid into their bank account in term one of the relevant academic year.

5.9 Aston Widening Participation Success Scheme

The Aston Widening Participation Success Scheme is targeted at new Home degree students who have a household income up to and including £42,875 and enrolling in the 2022/23 academic year.

A student is eligible to receive an Aston Widening Participation Success Scheme payment if:

(a) At enrolment the student meets the general provisions outlined in Section 4, and
(b) the student is regarded as a "home student" for fee purposes, is eligible to receive UK student support funding, and
(c) the student has currently been assessed by either Student Finance England, Student Finance Wales, Student Finance Northern Ireland or Student Awards Agency for Scotland to have a household income of up to and including £42,875, and
(d) the student has completed formal enrolment an all associated checks related to enrolment including qualifications have been confirmed by the end of Term 1, and
(e) the student is not receiving the Aston Success Scheme, a student can only receive either the Aston Widening Participation Success Scheme or the Aston Success Scheme, they are unable to receive both of these schemes in any academic year.

A student who is awarded the Aston Widening Participation Success Scheme will be eligible when they enter stage 1 of a programme of study to receive a credit of £50 paid into their bank account in term one.

In each subsequent stage of study excluding the placement year, provided they continue to meet all the general conditions as set out in Section 4 they will receive a credit of £50 paid into their bank account in term one of the relevant academic year.

Where the relevant household income information is not available to make a payment within term one, payments will be made within ten working days of receipt of confirmation of the information household income up to and including 31st May 2023. The household income thresholds used to assess eligibility for the award of this scheme will only be reviewed once in the academic year where a student enters stage 1 of a programme of study and will be based on the first assessment where income is available.

5.10 Aston Alumni Undergraduate Scholarships

The Aston Alumni Undergraduate Scholarship is an application-based scholarship. A student must apply for the Aston Alumni Undergraduate Scholarship. If the student is successful in the application process, the student must agree to the responsibilities expected of them as listed in 5.10.3.

A student is eligible to receive an Aston Alumni Undergraduate Scholarship if:

(f) the student meets the general provisions outlined in Section 4, and
(g) the student is regarded as a "home student" for fee purposes, is eligible to receive UK student support funding, and
(h) the student is assessed by either Student Finance England, Student Finance Wales, Student Finance Northern Ireland or Student Awards Agency for Scotland as having a household income of up to and including £18,000. This assessment must have been carried out and finalised and available to the university by the 30 September 2022, with all required evidence submitted and received to by the relevant Student Loans Agency by the 9 September 2022.
(i) the student meets at least one of the selection criteria as specified on the application form for this scholarship.
(j) the student meets all deadlines for application submission
(k) the assessor deems that the student should be offered the scholarship based on the application submitted.

The decision of the assessor is final and any appeal against the decision can only be made based on an administrative of procedural irregularity.

A student who is awarded an Aston Alumni Undergraduate Scholarship will be eligible to receive:

(a) A payment of £1000, paid into their bank account in the first term when they enter stage 1 of a programme of study and have successfully proven their household income.
(b) An additional payment of £1,000, paid in two equal instalments of £500 into their bank account in the second and third terms, when they enter stage 1 of a programme of study and have successfully proven their household income.
(c) In stage 2 and stage F of study, provided they continue to meet all the general conditions as set out in Section 4, they will receive a payment of £1,500 paid in three equal instalments of £500 into their bank account in the first, second and third terms.

5.10.1 The Alumni Undergraduate Scholarship will be either awarded under the title 'Alumni Undergraduate Scholarship' or it may be titled after a specific alumni donor (Alumni Named Undergraduate Scholarship).

5.10.2 Should a student fail to uphold their responsibilities in relation to the Aston Alumni Undergraduate Scholarship Award their scholarship could be revoked.

5.10.3 Responsibilities for recipients of an Aston Alumni Undergraduate Scholarship

Upon receipt of an Aston Alumni Undergraduate the student agrees:

(a) through the Stewardship Manager in the Alumni Relations & Development Office to maintain contact with the Donor or their family by way of an annual communication within specified deadlines;
(b) through the Stewardship Manager in the Alumni Relations & Development Office meet the donor if required and, where this occurs, the meeting will be arranged and attended by a representative from the Alumni Relations & Development Office;
(c) on reasonable request from the Stewardship Manager in the Alumni Relations & Development Office, participate in periodic events organised by the University at which some of the donors or their family might be present;
(d) comply with any reasonable request from the Alumni Relations & Development Office.

6. QUALIFICATIONS AND GRADES THAT QUALIFY FOR THE ASTON ACHIEVEMENT SCHOLARSHIP OR ASTON VICE-CHANCELLORS ACHIEVEMENT SCHOLARSHIP FOR 2022/23 ENTRY

UK undergraduate students starting degree programmes in 2022/23 holding one of the following qualifications or combinations of qualifications and grades will be eligible to be considered for an Aston Achievement Scholarship or an Aston Vice-Chancellors Achievement Scholarship. Students do not have to apply separately for the Aston Achievement or Aston Vice-Chancellors Achievement Scholarship. Eligibility is normally confirmed via the UCAS process on publication of results and on enrolment at Aston University.

Aston University is not able to consider other alternative qualifications or combinations of qualifications or grades for the Aston Achievement Scholarship or Aston Vice-Chancellors Achievement Scholarship but does admit and make offers to students who have lower or different qualifications. The qualifications listed below do not guarantee entry to Aston University as our requirements may include particular grades in specific subjects.

Acceptable grade/qualification combinations are as shown in the tables below:

Qualifications	**Grades**
A-levels (best 3 grades)	A*, A*, A* A*, A*, A A*, A*, B

A Double Award A-level counts as two single awards at the grade awarded. International A Levels (Cambridge International A Level, Oxford International AQA A Level and Pearson Edexcel International Advanced Level) are also accepted qualifications	A*, A*, C A*, A*, D A*, A*, E A*, A, A A*, A, B A*, A, C A*, A, D A*, A, E A*, B, B A* B, C A*, B, D A*,C, C A, A, A A, A, B A, A, C A, A, D A, B, B A, B, C B, B, B

Qualifications	**Grades**
Level 3 BTEC Nationals (QCF/RQF) *from the suite of qualifications that include:* • *1 x BTEC National Extended Diploma (RQF)* • *1 x BTEC Extended Diploma (QCF)* • *3 x BTEC Subsidiary Diplomas(QCF)* • *3 x BTEC National Extended Certificate (RQF)* • *1 x BTEC Diploma (QCF) +1 x subsidiary diploma (QCF)* • *1 x BTEC Diploma (QCF) + 1 x National Extended Certificate (RQF)* • *1 x BTEC National Diploma (RQF) + 1 x subsidiary diploma (QCF)* • *1 x BTEC National Diploma (RQF) + 1 x BTEC National Extended Certificate (RQF)*	Distinction*, Distinction*, Distinction* Distinction*, Distinction*, Distinction Distinction*, Distinction, Distinction Distinction, Distinction, Distinction
2 x BTEC 90 Credit Diplomas (QCF)	Distinction*, Distinction*, Distinction*, Distinction* Distinction*, Distinction*, Distinction*, Distinction

Qualifications	Grades
	Distinction*, Distinction*, Distinction, Distinction Distinction*, Distinction, Distinction, Distinction Distinction, Distinction, Distinction, Distinction
2 x BTEC National Foundation Diploma (RQF)	Distinction*, Distinction* Distinction*, Distinction Distinction, Distinction
OCR National Extended Diploma	Grade D1
OCR National Diploma + OCR National Certificate	Grade D, Grade D
3 x OCR National Certificates	Grade D, Grade D, Grade D
OCR Level 3 Cambridge Technical Extended Diploma	Distinction*, Distinction*, Distinction* Distinction*, Distinction*, Distinction Distinction*, Distinction, Distinction Distinction, Distinction, Distinction
1 x OCR Level 3 Cambridge Technical Diploma + 1 x OCR Level 3 Cambridge Technical Introductory Diploma	Distinction*, Distinction* + Distinction* Distinction*, Distinction* + Distinction Distinction*, Distinction + Distinction Distinction, Distinction + Distinction

Qualifications	Grades
3 x OCR Level 3 Cambridge Technical Introductory Diplomas	Distinction*, Distinction*, Distinction* Distinction*, Distinction*, Distinction Distinction*, Distinction, Distinction Distinction, Distinction, Distinction
2 x OCR Level 3 Cambridge Technical Subsidiary Diplomas	Distinction*, Distinction*, Distinction* Distinction*, Distinction*, Distinction*, Distinction Distinction*, Distinction*. Distinction, Distinction Distinction*, Distinction, Distinction, Distinction Distinction, Distinction, Distinction, Distinction
Scottish Advanced Highers (best 3 grades)	A, A, A A, A, B A, B, B A, A, C B, B, B A, A, D A, B, C
International Baccalaureate	Minimum of 31 points, with 5,5,5 in Higher Level Subjects
Irish Leaving Certificates – Higher Level (best 4 grades)	Final Award 2016: A1, A1, A1, A1 A1, A1, A1, A2 A1, A1, A1, B1 A1, A1, B1, B1 A1, B1, B1, B1 B1, B1, B1, B1 First Award 2017: H1, H1, H1, H1 H1, H1, H1, H2 H1, H1, H2, H2

Qualifications	Grades
	H1, H2, H2, H2 H2, H2, H2, H2
3 x Cambridge International Pre-U Certificate OR **2 x Cambridge International Pre-U Certificate and 1 x Global Perspectives and Research** **Please note the Cambridge International Pre-U Certificate (Short Course) is not acceptable**	DI/D2 D1/D2 D1/D2 D1/D2 D1/D2 D3 D1/D2 D1/D2 M1 D1/D2 D1/D2 M2 D1/D2 D1/D2 M3 D1/D2 D1/D2 P1 D1/D2 D3 D3 D1/D2 D3 M1 D1/D2 D3 M2 D1/D2 D3 M3 D1/D2 M1 M1 D1/D2 M1 M2 D3 D3 D3 D3 D3 M1 D3 D3 M2 D3 M1 M1 M1 M1 M1 M1 M1 M2 M1 M2 M2 M2 M2 M2
A postgraduate research degree	
A postgraduate taught degree	
A first degree	

Qualification	Grades	
1 x A level + **2 x Level 3 BTEC Subsidiary Diplomas (QCF) or National Extended Certificate (RQF)**	*A level grade* A* A A* A A* A B B B	*BTEC grades* Distinction*, Distinction* Distinction*, Distinction* Distinction*, Distinction Distinction*, Distinction Distinction, Distinction Distinction, Distinction Distinction*, Distinction* Distinction*, Distinction* Distinction*, Distinction
2 x A level + **1 x Level 3 BTEC Subsidiary Diplomas (QCF) or National Extended Certificate (RQF)**	*A level grades* A*, A* A*, A* A*, A A*, A A, A A, A A*, B A*, B A, B A, B	*BTEC grade* Distinction* Distinction Distinction* Distinction Distinction* Distinction Distinction* Distinction Distinction*

Qualification	Grades	
	A*, C	Distinction
	A*, C	Distinction*
	BB	Distinction
	BB	Distinction*
		Distinction
1 x A level + **1 x Level 3 BTEC Diploma (QCF) OR** **1 x Level 3 BTEC National Diploma (RQF)**	*A level grade* A* A A* A A* A B B B	*BTEC grades* Distinction*, Distinction* Distinction*, Distinction* Distinction*, Distinction Distinction*, Distinction` Distinction, Distinction Distinction, Distinction Distinction*, Distinction* Distinction*, Distinction Distinction, Distinction
2 x A levels + **1 x OCR National Certificate**	*A level grades* A*, A* A*, A A, A A*, B A, B B, B	*OCR grade* Distinction Distinction Distinction Distinction Distinction Distinction
2 x A levels + **1 x OCR Cambridge Technical Introductory Diploma**	*A level grades* A*, A* A*, A* A*, A A*, A A, A A, A A*, B A*, B A, B A, B A*, C A, C	*OCR grade* Distinction* Distinction Distinction* Distinction Distinction* Distinction Distinction* Distinction Distinction* Distinction Distinction* Distinction
1 x A level + **2 x OCR National Certificates**	*A level grade* A* A B	*OCR grades* Distinction, Distinction Distinction, Distinction Distinction, Distinction
1 x A level + **2 x OCR Cambridge Technical Introductory Diplomas**	*A level grade* A* A A* A A*	*OCR grades* Distinction*, Distinction* Distinction*, Distinction* Distinction*, Distinction Distinction*, Distinction` Distinction, Distinction

Qualification	Grades	
	A	Distinction, Distinction
	B	Distinction*, Distinction*
	B	Distinction*, Distinction
	B	Distinction, Distinction
1 x A level + **1 x OCR National Diploma**	*A level grade* A* A B	*OCR grades* Distinction Distinction Distinction
1 x A level + **1 x OCR Cambridge Technical Diploma**	*A level grade* A* A A* A A* A B B B	*OCR grades* Distinction*, Distinction* Distinction*, Distinction* Distinction*, Distinction Distinction*, Distinction` Distinction, Distinction Distinction, Distinction Distinction*, Distinction* Distinction*, Distinction Distinction, Distinction
2 x A levels + **1 x Cambridge Pre-U Certificate** **OR** **2 x A-Levels and 1 x Cambridge International Pre-U Certificate in Global Perspectives and Independent Research Grade Tariff**	*A level grade* A*, A* A*, A A, A A*, B A*, C A*, D A*, A* A*, A A, A A*, B A, B A*, A* A*, A A, A A*, B A*, A* A*, A A, A A*, B	*Cambridge Pre-U grade* D1/D2 D1/D2 D1/D2 D1/D2 D1/D2 D1/D2 D3 D3 D3 D3 D3 M1 M1 M1 M1 M2 M2 M2 M2
1 x A level + **2 x Cambridge Pre-U Certificates** **OR 1 x A-Level + 1 x Cambridge Pre-U Certificates + 1 x Cambridge International Pre-U Certificate in Global Perspectives and Independent Research Grade Tariff**	*A level grade* A* A A* A B A* A B A* A B	*Cambridge Pre-U grade* D1/D2, D1/D2 D1/D2, D1/D2 D1/D2, D1/D2 D1/D2, D3 D1/D2, D3 D1/D2, D3 D3, D3 D3, D3 M1/M2, M1/M2 M1/M2, M1/M2 M1/M2, M1/M2

Qualification	Grades
2 x A level + 1 x IFS Diploma in Financial Studies	A*, A*, A* A*, A*, A A*, A*, B A*, A*, C A*, A*, D A*, A*, E A*, A, A A*, A, B A*, A, C A*, A, D A*, A, E A*, B, B A* B, C A*, B, D A*,C, C A, A, A A, A, B A, A, C A, A, D A, B, B A, B, C B, B, B
2 x A Levels + 1 x Welsh Baccalaureate - Advanced Skills Challenge Certificate (first teaching September 2015)	A*, A*, A* A*, A*, A A*, A*, B A*, A*, C A*, A*, D A*, A*, E A*, A, A A*, A, B A*, A, C A*, A, D A*, A, E A*, B, B A* B, C A*, B, D A*,C, C A, A, A A, A, B A, A, C A, A, D A, B, B A, B, C B, B, B
Access to Higher Education Diploma	Overall Pass - must include 45 credits at Level 3, of which 30 credits must be at Distinction and 15 at Merit or higher